W. Matthew Alampay Davis

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Department of Economics
Columbia University
New York, NY 10027

Education

Columbia University	University of Oxford	New York University
Dept. of Economics, GSAS	Nuffield College	Stern School of Business
Ph.D Economics (2025)	*M.Phil* Economics (2019)	*B.Sc* Business & Political Economy (2015)

Research

Development Economics · Environmental/Climate Economics · Political Economy

Job market paper

Climate inequality

This paper documents new evidence that transitory temperature shocks increase within-country income inequality persistently then considers its implications for the welfare economics of climate change. Estimation proceeds by adapting macroeconomic time series methods to distributional national accounts data. Results constitute the first comprehensive characterization of the dynamic effects of temperature shocks on distributions of income. I then integrate the implied "damage functions" with outputs from new-generation climate models to simulate the effects of anthropogenic climate forcings on distributions of income aggregated globally both retrospectively and under a suite of future warming scenarios. Finally, I integrate these results into a stylized model in which a variety of social welfare functions are mapped to optimal fiscal policy, suggesting an overlooked first-order role for redistributive climate policy within and across national borders.

Work in progress

Political transition under environmental pressure

Economic disruption, cultural anti-persistence, and intimate-partner violence
with Tanushree Goyal

Elite capture and identity politics: A formal model of substantive representation

Publications

Large potential reduction in economic damages under UN mitigation targets
with Marshall Burke, Noah S. Diffenbaugh — *Nature* (2018)

Combining satellite imagery and machine learning to predict poverty
with Neal Jean, Marshall Burke, Michael Xie, David B. Lobell, Stefano Ermon — *Science* (2016)

Referee service

Journal of Development Economics

Teaching

Graduate Teaching Fellow at Columbia University (nine semesters, 2020–2024)
Research consultant to all UG/MA economics thesis writers and research assistants
ECON-4999 – Senior honors thesis workshops (design and instruction)
ECON-3412 – Introduction to econometrics (TA)
ECON-3211 – Intermediate microeconomics (TA)
ECON-2257 – The global economy (TA)

Past affiliations

Research associate at Climate Econometrics (2017–2019)
Nuffield College, University of Oxford
supervised by David F. Hendry, Elizabeth Baldwin

Pre-doctoral scholar at Center on Food Security and the Environment (2015–2017)
Dept. of Earth System Science, Stanford University
supervised by Marshall Burke, David Lobell

Honors

Program for Economic Research Summer Fellowship (2024)
Columbia economics department award supporting summer research activities

Wueller Fourth-Year Pre-Dissertation Award (2023)
Columbia economics department runner-up best dissertation proposal

UC Berkeley and Sloan Foundation Diversity Fellowship (2022)

Awarded to five doctoral students in environmental and energy economics

Columbia GSAS Dean's Fellowship and Dissertation Fellowship (2019)
Full-tuition scholarship and living stipend for up to six years of graduate study at Columbia

Oxford M.Phil top-scoring economics thesis (2019)
Department's first 'exceptional' (mark of 80+) thesis in at least four years

Nuffield College–Department of Economics Joint Studentship (2017)
Full-tuition scholarship and living stipend for up to four years of graduate study at Oxford

References

Administrators

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Personal

Background Philippines (nationality) · Indonesia (13 years) · Vietnam

Study and career United States · United Kingdom · China

Immediate family Philippines · Australia · Canada